Delivery Issues — Customer Knowledge Base

Late Delivery

A late delivery occurs when your order arrives past the originally estimated delivery time. This is one of the most common concerns customers raise, and understanding the underlying causes can help set appropriate expectations.

Common Causes Delivery delays often stem from factors outside anyone's immediate control. Heavy traffic during peak hours, road construction, or unexpected detours can significantly extend travel time. Weather conditions such as heavy rain, snow, or extreme heat may slow down riders for safety reasons. High demand periods—weekends, holidays, or local events—can also create backlogs as more orders compete for the same pool of delivery personnel. Additionally, restaurants or merchants may experience kitchen delays during busy periods, which pushes back the entire delivery timeline.

What to Expect When a delay occurs, you should receive updated timing information as soon as the system recalculates the estimated arrival. Riders typically prioritize safety over speed, so during adverse conditions, delays may extend beyond initial projections. Most platforms build buffer time into estimates, but real-world variables sometimes exceed those buffers.

Common Scenarios Imagine you ordered lunch at 12:00 PM with a 30-minute estimated delivery. By 12:45 PM, the food hasn't arrived. You check the tracking and see the rider is still at the restaurant —likely because the kitchen is overwhelmed with lunch rush orders. Alternatively, you might notice the rider moving slowly through traffic-heavy downtown streets during evening rush hour.

Resolution Possibilities If your order is significantly delayed, you may be eligible for compensation depending on platform policies. Some services offer partial refunds, credits toward future orders, or waive delivery fees. Contacting support with your order details is the best way to explore available options. In most cases, the order will still arrive; cancellation is typically only offered if the delay is excessive and the merchant agrees.

Special Cases If your order contains ice cream, frozen items, or hot meals that degrade in quality with time, mention this when contacting support. Temperature-sensitive orders may qualify for replacement or full refund even if they eventually arrive, as quality standards cannot be met after prolonged delays.

Rider Delayed

A rider delay specifically refers to situations where the assigned delivery person has not yet reached the restaurant or merchant to pick up your order, or has been stationary for an unusual amount of time.

Common Causes Riders may be delayed because they are completing another delivery before heading to your restaurant. They might also be stuck in traffic, dealing with vehicle issues, or navigating to a restaurant in a congested area. Sometimes riders accept orders while finishing previous tasks, which creates a gap between assignment and actual pickup. In rare cases, riders may be waiting at the restaurant because the order isn't ready yet, though the tracking may not clearly show this distinction.

What to Expect Once a rider is assigned, you should see their location and status updates in real time. If the rider is delayed reaching the restaurant, the pickup time will shift accordingly, and the delivery

estimate will update. Most platforms have protocols to reassign orders if a rider remains delayed beyond an acceptable threshold, though this may not be visible to you immediately.

Common Scenarios You place an order at 6:00 PM. By 6:25 PM, the rider is still several miles from the restaurant, not moving. They may be finishing a previous delivery across town. Alternatively, you might see the rider at the restaurant location but not marked as "picked up" for 15 minutes—this often means they're waiting for the kitchen to finish preparing the order.

Resolution Possibilities If the rider delay stretches beyond reasonable limits, the platform may automatically reassign your order to a closer or more available rider. You can also contact support to request a status check. If the delay makes the order no longer needed (for example, you had to leave for an appointment), support can assist with cancellation and refund options depending on preparation status.

Special Cases If you observe a rider moving in the wrong direction or making stops unrelated to your delivery, this may indicate they are multi-apping (working for multiple platforms simultaneously) or have accepted your order while still far away. While this is frustrating, platforms typically monitor rider efficiency and may take action based on patterns of behavior.

Rider Cannot Reach

This situation occurs when the delivery person is unable to access the delivery location due to physical barriers, access restrictions, or location confusion.

Common Causes Gated communities with entry codes, apartment complexes with locked main doors, office buildings requiring keycards, and private roads are frequent obstacles. Riders may also struggle with poorly marked addresses, missing unit numbers, or locations hidden behind other buildings. In some cases, the rider may have arrived at the correct address but cannot locate the specific entrance, floor, or wing.

What to Expect When a rider cannot reach you, they will typically attempt to contact you through the app or by phone. They may wait at the nearest accessible point for a reasonable period while attempting to reach you. If contact fails and access remains impossible, the rider may be forced to mark the delivery as failed, which usually triggers a return-to-sender process or disposal protocol depending on the item and platform policy.

Common Scenarios You live in a large apartment complex with multiple buildings. The rider arrives at the main gate but doesn't have the access code. They call twice, but you're in a meeting and don't see the calls. After waiting 10 minutes, they leave. Alternatively, you work in a high-rise office building where the lobby requires badge access. The rider is downstairs but cannot get past security without your escort.

Resolution Possibilities The best resolution is proactive communication. Include gate codes, building names, floor numbers, and any special instructions in your delivery notes. If the rider is struggling, responding quickly to their calls or messages can resolve the issue immediately. If the delivery fails due to access issues, you may need to reorder, though some platforms offer partial credits if the failure was due to missing information that you could have provided.

Special Cases For hospital deliveries, university campuses, or military bases, standard access protocols may not apply. These locations often have designated delivery drop-off points at main entrances or security checkpoints. Always verify whether your location has such protocols and communicate them clearly. Some secure facilities do not allow delivery personnel beyond certain points under any circumstances.

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Address Incorrect

An incorrect address situation arises when the delivery location provided during ordering does not match where the customer actually needs the order sent, or when the address contains errors that prevent successful delivery.

Common Causes Customers sometimes select old addresses from saved locations, accidentally tap the wrong address on a map, or make typos in street numbers or apartment units. Autocomplete features may suggest and fill in similar-sounding addresses in different neighborhoods. Some customers intentionally order to one location (like work) while planning to meet the rider elsewhere, which creates confusion.

What to Expect If the rider notices the address seems incorrect or unreachable, they will attempt to contact you for clarification. If you realize the error before the rider picks up the order, you may be able to update the address in the app depending on how far the rider has progressed. Once the rider is en route, address changes become more complicated and may incur additional fees if the new location is significantly farther.

Common Scenarios You recently moved and forgot to update your default address. The rider arrives at your old apartment building and calls, confused. Or you typed "123 Main Street" when you meant "123 Main Avenue"—two entirely different locations across town. Another common scenario: you ordered food to your office but decided to walk to a nearby park, expecting the rider to meet you there without updating the address.

Resolution Possibilities If caught early, address corrections are usually straightforward. Contact support immediately with the correct address and order details. If the rider hasn't picked up the order yet, the change is often seamless. If the rider has already traveled to the wrong address, the platform may charge a redelivery fee or require a new order. In cases where the order was delivered to the address as originally entered (even if that wasn't your intent), the platform's liability is typically limited, though exceptions exist for obvious errors.

Special Cases If the incorrect address is in a completely different city or delivery zone, the rider may not be authorized or able to travel there. Some platforms have strict geographic boundaries, and crossing them may be impossible. Additionally, if the incorrect address belongs to another customer, privacy and delivery integrity policies prevent the rider from simply leaving it there or redirecting it without proper authorization.

Contact Number Issue

Contact number issues occur when the rider cannot reach you by phone due to incorrect numbers, unreachable lines, or communication barriers.

Common Causes Customers may enter phone numbers with missing digits, wrong country codes, or outdated numbers. Some phones are set to block unknown numbers, send them straight to voicemail, or have "Do Not Disturb" modes activated. Network issues, dead batteries, or being in areas with poor signal can also prevent successful contact. In some regions, language barriers exist when the rider speaks a different language than the customer.

What to Expect Riders typically attempt to call multiple times and may leave a voicemail if possible. They also usually send messages through the app's chat function. If all contact methods fail after a

reasonable waiting period, the rider may proceed according to platform protocols—either leaving the order in a safe location, returning it, or marking it as failed delivery depending on the situation and location type.

Common Scenarios You ordered food while at a friend's house and used your home phone number. The rider calls your home line, but you're not there. Or you have a new phone number but haven't updated your account; the rider keeps getting a "number not in service" message. Another scenario: you're in a basement apartment with no cell service, and the rider is at your door but can't reach you to confirm the unit number.

Resolution Possibilities Always verify your contact number before placing an order. If you realize the number is wrong after ordering, update it in your account immediately and contact support to notify the rider. If the rider couldn't reach you but left the order in a safe place, check your app messages and photo confirmations. If the delivery failed entirely due to contact issues, you may need to reorder, though some platforms offer one-time courtesy credits if the number error was minor and the order was returnable.

Special Cases For international travelers or those using temporary local numbers, ensure the country code is correct and the number is active. Some platforms require number verification via SMS, which won't work with landlines or certain VoIP numbers. If you are deaf or hard of hearing, indicate this in your delivery notes and ensure the rider knows to use text-based communication rather than calling.

Rider Not Moving

This situation occurs when the assigned rider's location appears static on the tracking map for an extended period, creating uncertainty about whether the delivery is progressing.

Common Causes A stationary rider may be waiting at the restaurant for the order to be prepared, which is the most common explanation. They may also be stuck in severe traffic where movement is imperceptible at map scale, or parked legally while waiting for a traffic jam to clear. Technical issues with GPS tracking can make a moving rider appear stationary. In less common cases, the rider may be dealing with a personal emergency, vehicle breakdown, or app malfunction.

What to Expect Before assuming something is wrong, consider the context. If the rider is at the restaurant location, they are likely waiting for pickup. If they are on a highway during rush hour, they may be moving slowly. Tracking updates typically refresh every few minutes, so brief pauses are normal. However, if the rider remains in one location far from the restaurant for 15-20 minutes without status updates, there may be a genuine issue.

Common Scenarios You see the rider at the restaurant for 20 minutes. Rather than being lost or lazy, they are likely waiting for a complex order to be prepared during a busy period. Alternatively, the rider is shown in a residential neighborhood, not moving, for 30 minutes. They may have had a flat tire or be experiencing app issues that prevent them from updating their status or continuing deliveries.

Resolution Possibilities First, check if the order status has changed to "picked up" or if any messages have been sent. If the rider is at the restaurant, patience is usually the best approach. If the rider is stranded elsewhere, the platform may reassign the order automatically after a timeout period. You can contact support to request a status update or reassignment. If the delay is excessive, cancellation and reordering may be the fastest solution, with refund processing depending on whether the restaurant had already prepared the food.

Special Cases If the rider is shown at your address but not moving, and you haven't received your order, they may have completed the delivery but failed to update the app status, or they may be attempting to contact you. Check your surroundings and messages before concluding the delivery is incomplete. Some platforms also experience temporary tracking outages that affect all users in a region, making multiple riders appear stationary simultaneously.

Order Marked Delivered

An order marked delivered situation occurs when the system shows your order as completed, but you have not physically received it.

Common Causes Riders sometimes mark orders delivered prematurely to avoid late penalties, especially if they are running behind schedule. They may have delivered to the wrong address—similar street numbers, neighboring buildings, or incorrect apartment units. In some cases, the rider left the order at the door without knocking or calling, and it was taken by someone else, blown away by wind, or damaged by weather. Rarely, system glitches may update the status incorrectly without rider action.

What to Expect When an order is marked delivered, you should typically receive a notification and possibly a photo confirmation showing where the order was left. Check your immediate surroundings thoroughly—front door, lobby, mailroom, reception desk, and neighboring units. If you live in an apartment building, check with the leasing office or security desk, as riders sometimes leave orders there.

Common Scenarios You ordered dinner and received a "delivered" notification at 7:15 PM. You open your door and find nothing. The photo shows your neighbor's doormat. Or the rider delivered to 456 Oak Street instead of 456 Oak Avenue. Another scenario: the photo shows your correct door, but the order is gone—likely taken by a passerby before you checked.

Resolution Possibilities Contact support immediately with your order details. If the rider provided a delivery photo, review it carefully for clues about the actual drop-off location. Most platforms have policies for missing deliveries marked as completed. If the rider delivered to the wrong address, the platform will typically arrange redelivery or issue a full refund. If the order was stolen after correct delivery, policies vary—some platforms offer goodwill credits, while others consider the delivery complete once left at the specified address.

Special Cases For "leave at door" deliveries without recipient confirmation, liability depends on platform terms and local regulations. Some platforms require signature or photo proof for high-value orders. If you have security camera footage showing the rider never approached your door, this significantly strengthens your case for a full refund or redelivery. If the rider marked delivered but is still nearby, support may be able to contact them directly to return and complete the delivery properly.

Order Not Received

This situation covers cases where the delivery process appears complete from the system's perspective, but you genuinely never obtained your items, regardless of what the tracking indicates.

Common Causes Beyond the "marked delivered" scenarios, orders may not be received because the rider never attempted delivery—perhaps due to getting lost, giving up after access failures, or abandoning the delivery. Communication breakdowns where the rider tried to contact you but you were unavailable

can lead to the rider leaving without proper delivery. In rare cases, orders are picked up by the wrong person at crowded locations like office building lobbies or college dormitories.

What to Expect You should receive clear notifications at each stage: order confirmed, rider assigned, rider picked up, and delivered. If any stage is missing or the final delivery lacks confirmation details, this is a red flag. For high-value or sensitive orders, platforms may require signature confirmation or ID verification, which should be documented.

Common Scenarios You waited at your office building's main entrance for an hour. The rider never showed up, but later you see the order was marked as delivered to "front desk." Your building has no front desk. Or you live in a house with a clearly visible front door. The rider claims they knocked and waited, but you were home the entire time and heard nothing. Another case: you ordered medication with specific delivery instructions, but the order was left in an unsecured mailbox rather than handed to you as required.

Resolution Possibilities Report the issue to support as soon as you realize the order is missing. Provide specific details: where you were, whether you received any calls, what your delivery instructions specified, and any discrepancies in the delivery confirmation. Most platforms investigate by reviewing rider GPS logs, communication attempts, and delivery photos. If the investigation confirms non-delivery, you will typically receive a full refund or replacement order. If the investigation is inconclusive, outcomes depend on your order history and the platform's goodwill policies.

Special Cases For orders requiring age verification (alcohol, tobacco, certain medications), the rider must confirm recipient identity. If you were not present and the rider left these items anyway, this is a serious policy violation that should be reported immediately, as it may have legal implications. Similarly, if you have a "hand it to me" instruction and the rider left the order without interaction, this constitutes incomplete delivery even if the items are eventually found.

Delivery Rescheduled

Delivery rescheduling occurs when the originally planned delivery time is changed to a later time, either by the platform, the merchant, or at the customer's request.

Common Causes Rescheduling may happen because the merchant is temporarily closed, experiencing equipment failure, or has run out of key ingredients. Riders may become unavailable due to shift changes or emergencies, requiring reassignment to later slots. Customers themselves may request rescheduling if they won't be available during the original window. Severe weather events or local emergencies can force platform-wide rescheduling for safety reasons.

What to Expect You should receive explicit notification of the new delivery time with the reason for rescheduling, if available. The new estimate should be realistic based on current conditions. If the rescheduled time no longer works for you, most platforms allow you to cancel without penalty since the change was initiated by their side. If you requested the reschedule, standard cancellation policies may apply depending on timing.

Common Scenarios You ordered a cake for a 3:00 PM party with 2:00 PM delivery. At 1:30 PM, you receive a message that the bakery's oven malfunctioned and your order is rescheduled for 5:00 PM, which is after your party. Or you selected "deliver between 6-7 PM" but the platform reschedules to 8:30 PM due to high demand. Another scenario: you realize you'll be stuck in meetings, so you contact support to push your lunch delivery from 12:00 PM to 2:00 PM.

Resolution Possibilities For merchant-initiated reschedules, you typically have the right to cancel for a full refund if the new time is inconvenient. For platform-initiated reschedules due to operational issues, compensation in the form of credits or discounts is sometimes offered automatically. Customer-initiated reschedules are usually honored if requested before the rider picks up the order; after pickup, changes may be impossible or may require the rider to return to the merchant, which incurs complications.

Special Cases Time-sensitive orders—birthday cakes, anniversary dinners, medication deliveries—may become useless if rescheduled. For these, platforms often have escalation paths that prioritize finding alternative solutions, such as sourcing from different merchants or expediting with premium riders. If a reschedule would cause the order to arrive after a business closes (for office deliveries) or after you've left a temporary location, immediate cancellation is usually the only viable option.

Delivery Failed

A delivery failure is the final status when an order could not be completed and returned to the merchant, disposed of, or otherwise not delivered to the customer.

Common Causes Failures typically result from persistent access issues, unresponsiveness to rider contact, incorrect addresses that make the location unreachable, or customer refusal of the order. Rider emergencies or vehicle breakdowns that prevent completion may also lead to failures. In some cases, the merchant cancels the order after the rider has already been assigned, converting what would be a cancellation into a delivery failure from the rider's perspective.

What to Expect When a delivery fails, you should receive a notification explaining the failure reason and the next steps. Depending on platform policy and the reason for failure, you may receive an automatic refund, a credit, or instructions to contact support. If the failure was due to customer-side issues (unreachable, wrong address, refusal), refund eligibility may be limited or partial.

Common Scenarios You fell asleep waiting for a late-night delivery and didn't hear the rider's calls. After multiple attempts, the rider marks the delivery as failed. You wake up to a notification and no food. Or you provided an office address for a Saturday delivery, forgetting the building is locked on weekends. The rider cannot enter and eventually marks the delivery failed. Another scenario: the order arrives severely damaged (spilled soup, crushed packaging) and you refuse to accept it, leading the rider to mark it as failed delivery.

Resolution Possibilities If the failure was due to platform, rider, or merchant issues, you are typically entitled to a full refund or replacement without question. If the failure stemmed from incorrect information or unavailability on your part, policies vary. Some platforms offer one-time courtesy refunds for first-time failures, while others deduct the cost or offer only partial credits. Contacting support with honest, detailed information is the best path to resolution. If the order was prepaid and returned to the merchant, some platforms can reattempt delivery the same day if the issue is resolved quickly.

Special Cases For perishable items like fresh groceries, ice cream, or hot meals, failed deliveries usually mean the items cannot be redelivered later—the merchant must prepare fresh items, which requires a new order. High-value items or restricted goods (alcohol, age-restricted products) have specific failure protocols that may involve returning to the merchant and additional verification steps for any future delivery attempts. If a delivery fails multiple times for the same order, the platform may permanently cancel the order and issue a refund, as repeated attempts become economically unfeasible.

This document is intended for customer support training and knowledge base reference. Each section can be extracted and used independently as a standalone article.